

14

King's Indian Tactical Patterns

See the geometry behind ...f4, ...g4, dark-square entry, and central blows



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

Recognize recurring tactical mechanisms while verifying every move concretely.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 079 | PAGE 4

Decode: The f4 wedge*The wedge restricts; another move must open access.*

LESSON 080 | PAGE 8

Play: The f4 wedge*The wedge restricts; another move must open access.*

LESSON 081 | PAGE 12

Decode: The g4 contact*Pattern recognition finds the move; calculation earns it.*

LESSON 082 | PAGE 16

Play: The g4 contact*Pattern recognition finds the move; calculation earns it.*

LESSON 083 | PAGE 20

Decode: The counterblow during the race*Every contact resets the calculation tree.*

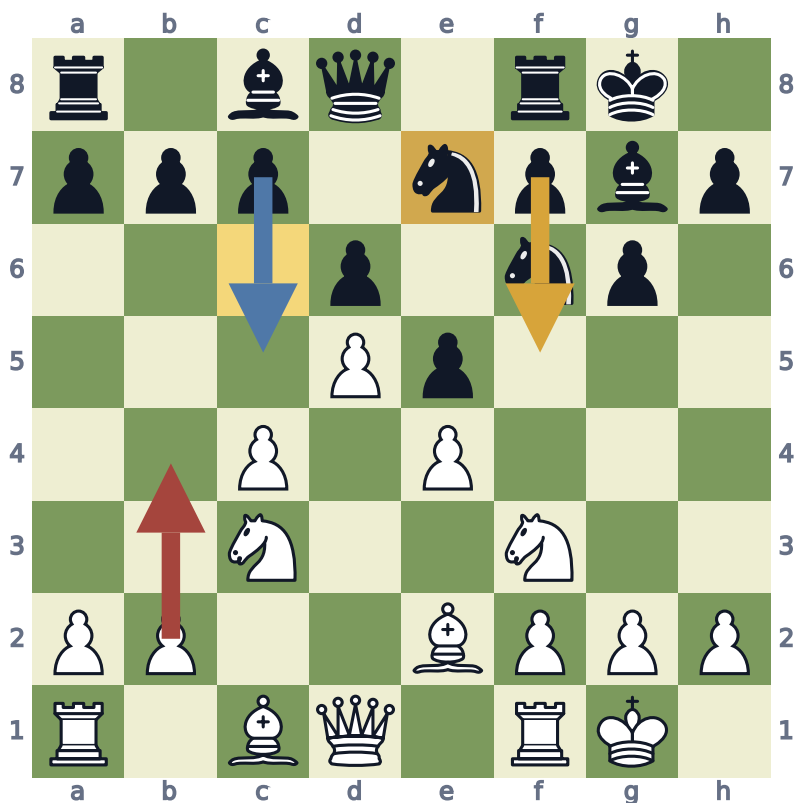
LESSON 084 | PAGE 24

Play: The counterblow during the race*Every contact resets the calculation tree.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

Recognize recurring tactical mechanisms while verifying every move concretely.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The f4 wedge

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

The pawn on f4 gains space, restricts g3 and e3, and prepares piece entry, but it also closes the f-file until contact is created.

DECISION RULE

Decide whether ...g5, ...g4, or a piece maneuver is the next forcing step.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Bring pieces toward g4, h4, and f4 before opening the structure.

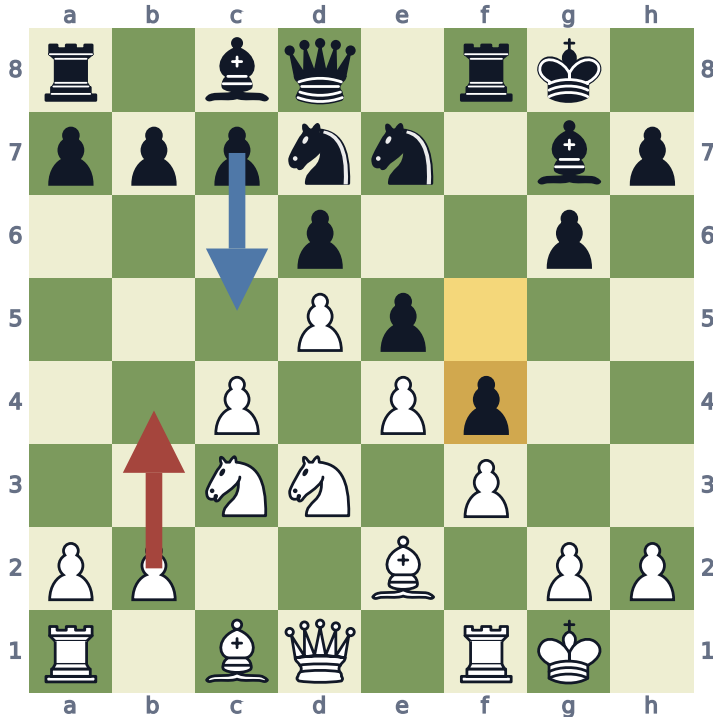
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may play g4, h3, or c5 and race on the other wing.

MEMORY RULE | The wedge restricts; another move must open access.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The pawn on f4 gains space, restricts g3 and e3, and prepares piece entry, but it also closes the f-file until contact is created.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Bring pieces toward g4, h4, and f4 before opening the structure.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White may play g4, h3, or c5 and race on the other wing.

FAILURE MODE

Advancing the pawn wall without pieces creates targets instead of threats.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Decide whether ...g5, ...g4, or a piece maneuver is the next forcing step. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

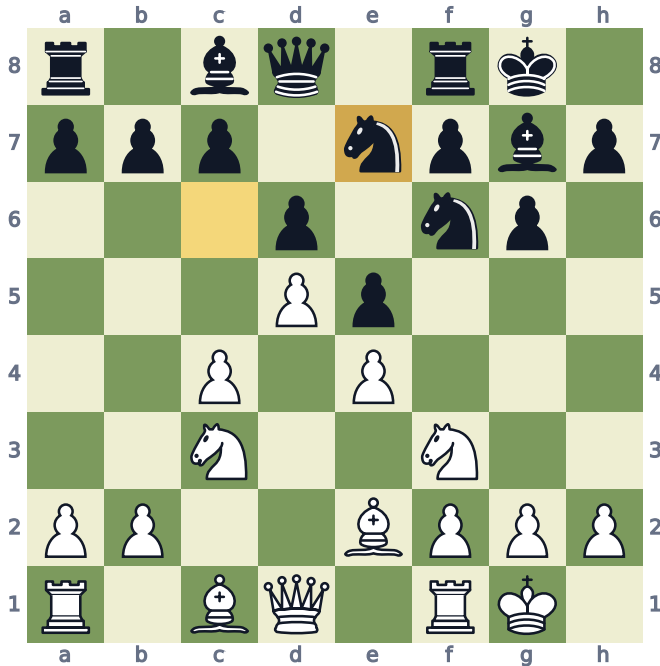
RULE | The wedge restricts; another move must open access.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. f3 f4



- Be2: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- e5: Black makes direct central contact and asks whether White will close, capture, or maintain tension.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight toward c6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- d5: White claims space or creates a break that changes Black's available time and squares.
- Ne7: Black reroutes a knight toward e7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The pawn on f4 gains space, restricts g3 and e3, and prepares piece entry, but it also closes the f-file until contact is created.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Decide whether ...g5, ...g4, or a piece maneuver is the next forcing step. White's resistance is: White may play g4, h3, or c5 and race on the other wing. The line fails as a template when: Advancing the pawn wall without pieces creates targets instead of threats.

STORE THIS | The wedge restricts; another move must open access.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

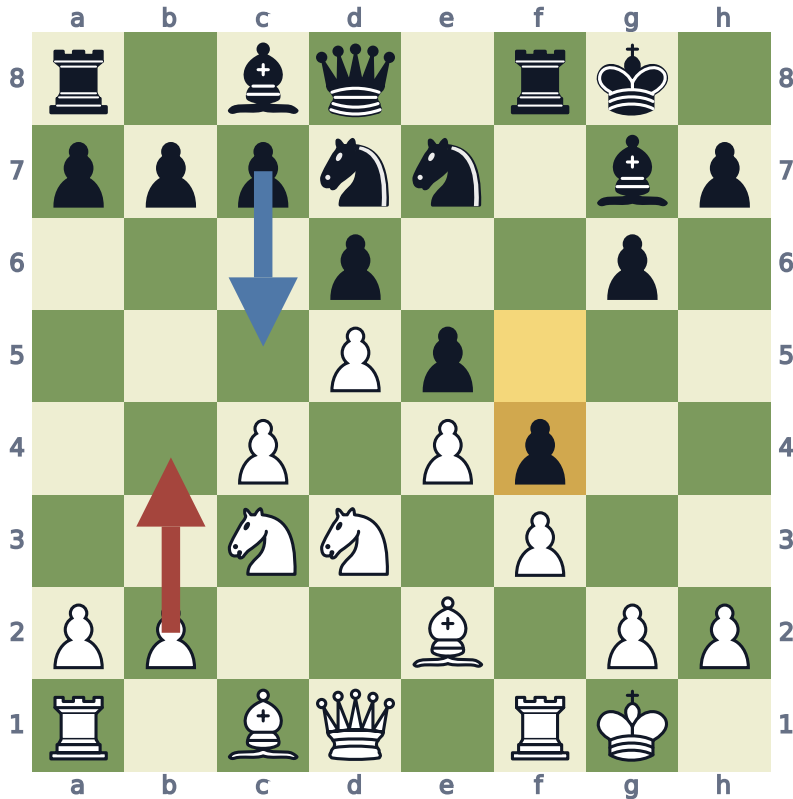
1. The pawn on f4 gains space, restricts g3 and e3, and prepares piece entry, but it also closes the f-file until contact is created. 2. Bring pieces toward g4, h4, and f4 before opening the structure. 3. White may play g4, h3, or c5 and race on the other wing. 4. Decide whether ...g5, ...g4, or a piece maneuver is the next forcing step. 5. Advancing the pawn wall without pieces creates targets instead of threats.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The f4 wedge



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The pawn on f4 gains space, restricts g3 and e3, and prepares piece entry, but it also closes the f-file until contact is created.

DECISION RULE

Decide whether ...g5, ...g4, or a piece maneuver is the next forcing step.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Bring pieces toward g4, h4, and f4 before opening the structure.

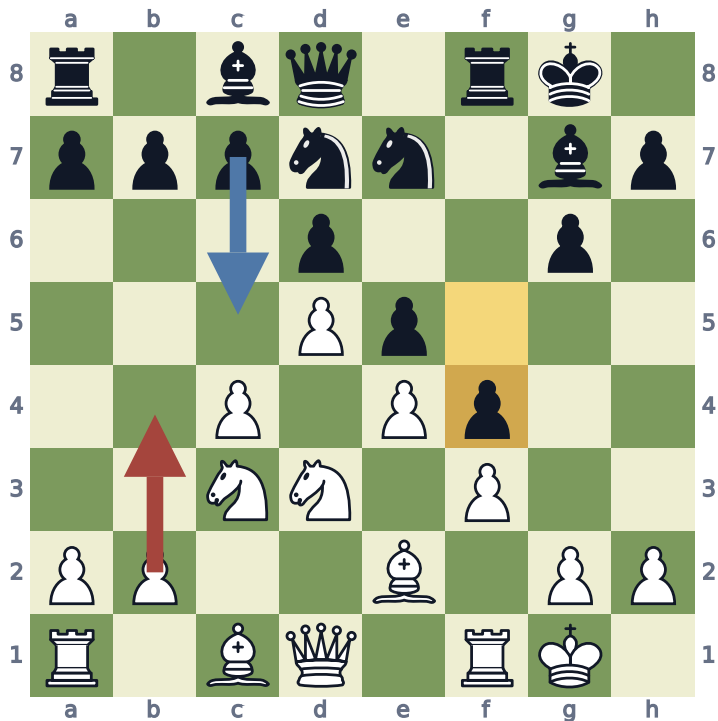
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White may play g4, h3, or c5 and race on the other wing.

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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The pawn on f4 gains space, restricts g3 and e3, and prepares piece entry, but it also closes the f-file until contact is created.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Bring pieces toward g4, h4, and f4 before opening the structure.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White may play g4, h3, or c5 and race on the other wing.

FAILURE MODE

Advancing the pawn wall without pieces creates targets instead of threats.

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Ask: Decide whether ...g5, ...g4, or a piece maneuver is the next forcing step. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

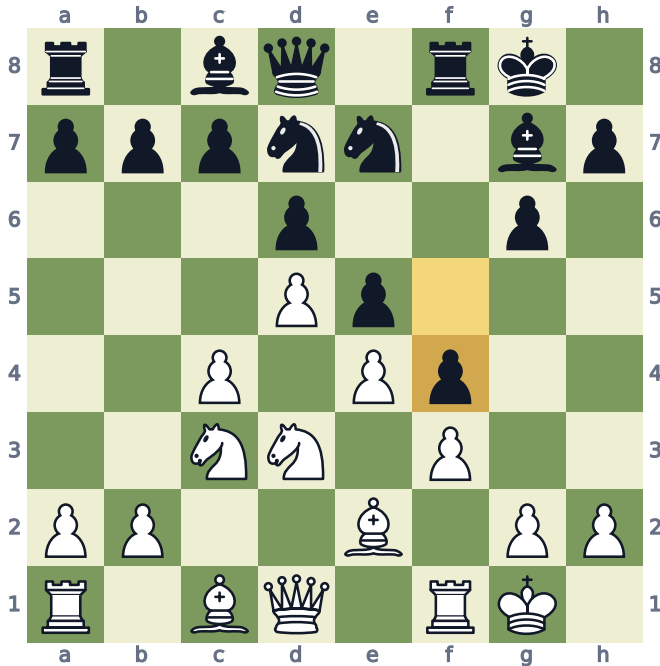
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Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. f3 f4



- Ne1: White reroutes a knight toward e1; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight toward d7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nd3: White reroutes a knight toward d3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- f5: Black begins the thematic kingside break, but its value depends on piece support and race timing.
- f3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- f4: Black gains or fixes kingside space and prepares line-opening contact for the pieces.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The pawn on f4 gains space, restricts g3 and e3, and prepares piece entry, but it also closes the f-file until contact is created.

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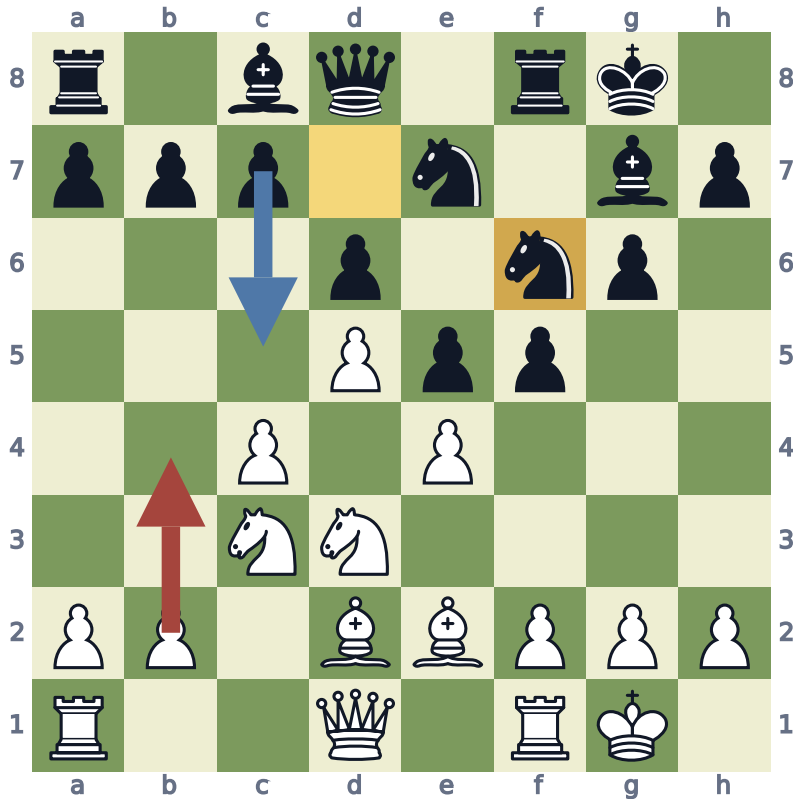
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 22 plies from memory, then replay: 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. f3 f4

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The g4 contact

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

The g-pawns create a hook, and ...h5 can force a file or fix White's shelter for a later sacrifice.

DECISION RULE

Count effective attackers and defenders before every pawn sacrifice.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Calculate captures on g4 and h4 with queen and rook routes included.

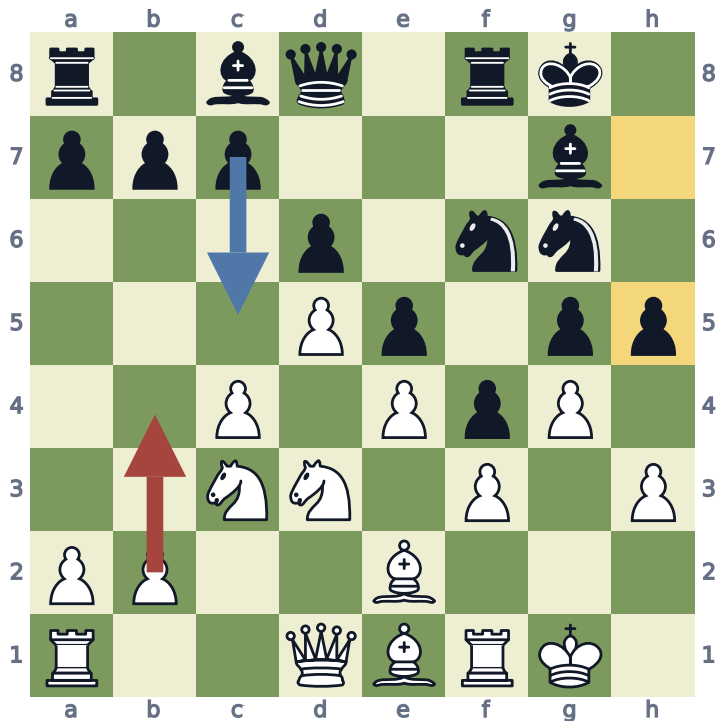
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White tries to keep the kingside closed while breaking with c5.

MEMORY RULE | Pattern recognition finds the move; calculation earns it.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The g-pawns create a hook, and ...h5 can force a file or fix White's shelter for a later sacrifice.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Calculate captures on g4 and h4 with queen and rook routes included.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White tries to keep the kingside closed while breaking with c5.

FAILURE MODE

A familiar attacking shape does not prove a sacrifice.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Count effective attackers and defenders before every pawn sacrifice. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

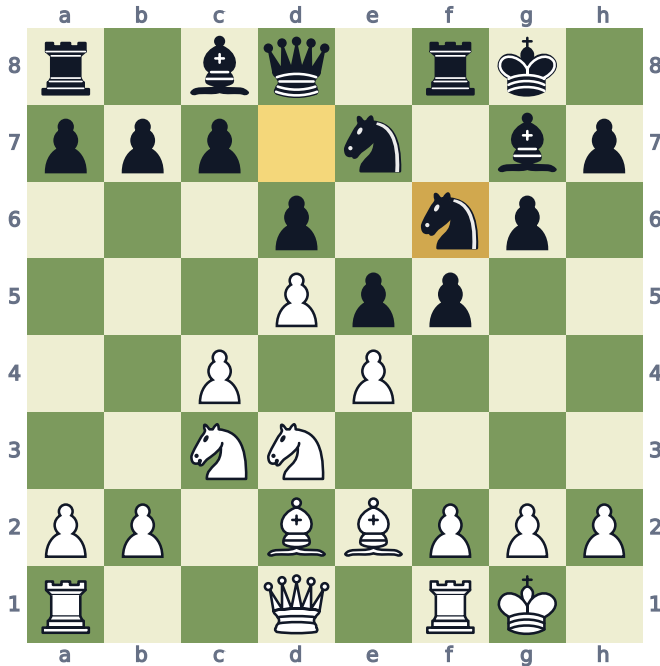
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. Bd2 Nf6 12. f3 f4 13. Be1 g5 14. g4 Ng6 15. h3 h5



- Ne1: White reroutes a knight toward e1; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight toward d7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nd3: White reroutes a knight toward d3; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- f5: Black begins the thematic kingside break, but its value depends on piece support and race timing.
- Bd2: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight toward f6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The g-pawns create a hook, and ...h5 can force a file or fix White's shelter for a later sacrifice.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Count effective attackers and defenders before every pawn sacrifice. White's resistance is: White tries to keep the kingside closed while breaking with c5. The line fails as a template when: A familiar attacking shape does not prove a sacrifice.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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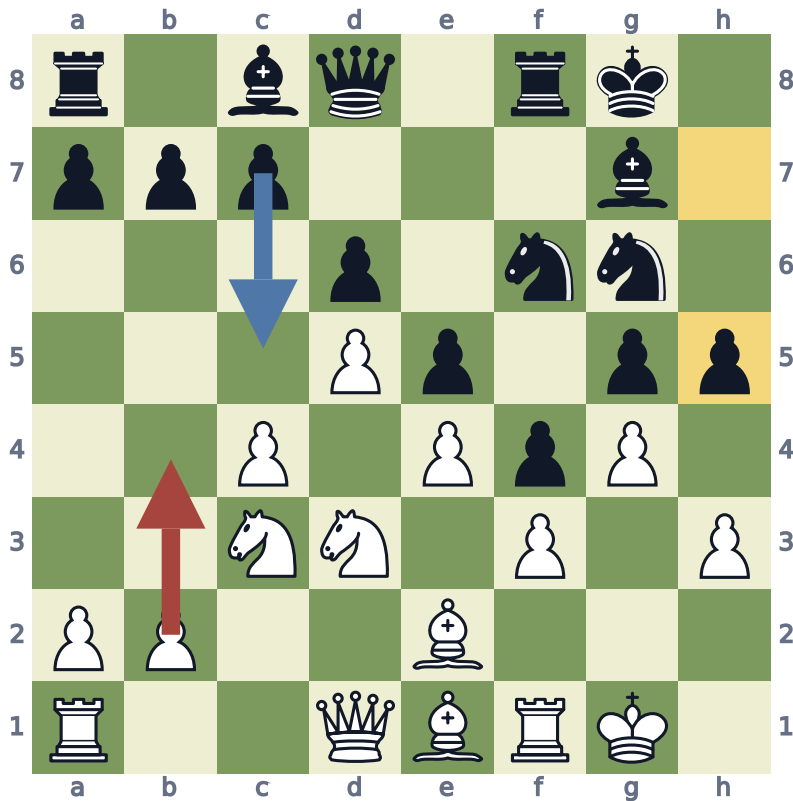
1. The g-pawns create a hook, and ...h5 can force a file or fix White's shelter for a later sacrifice. 2. Calculate captures on g4 and h4 with queen and rook routes included. 3. White tries to keep the kingside closed while breaking with c5. 4. Count effective attackers and defenders before every pawn sacrifice. 5. A familiar attacking shape does not prove a sacrifice.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 22 plies from memory, then replay: 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. Bd2 Nf6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The g4 contact



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The g-pawns create a hook, and ...h5 can force a file or fix White's shelter for a later sacrifice.

DECISION RULE

Count effective attackers and defenders before every pawn sacrifice.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Calculate captures on g4 and h4 with queen and rook routes included.

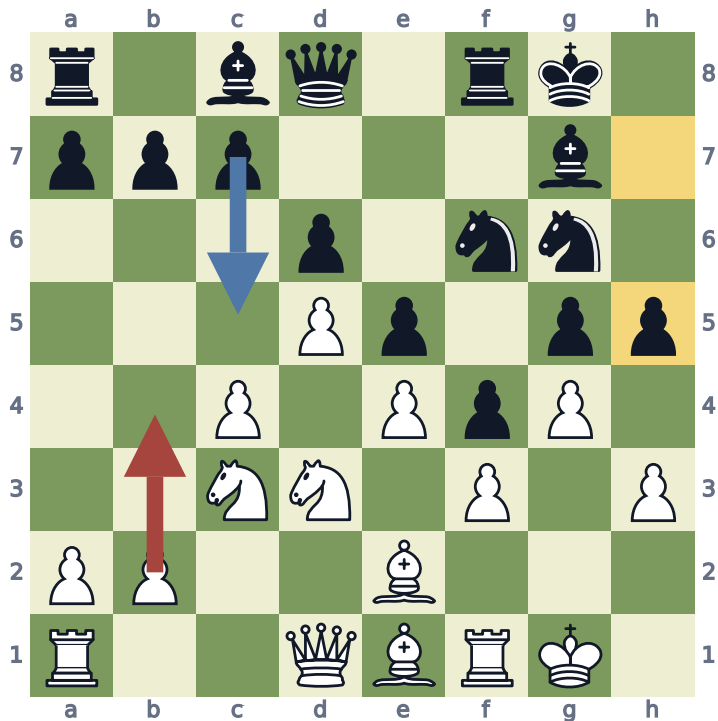
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White tries to keep the kingside closed while breaking with c5.

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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

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CUE

The g-pawns create a hook, and ...h5 can force a file or fix White's shelter for a later sacrifice.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Calculate captures on g4 and h4 with queen and rook routes included.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White tries to keep the kingside closed while breaking with c5.

FAILURE MODE

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DECISION TEST

Ask: Count effective attackers and defenders before every pawn sacrifice. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

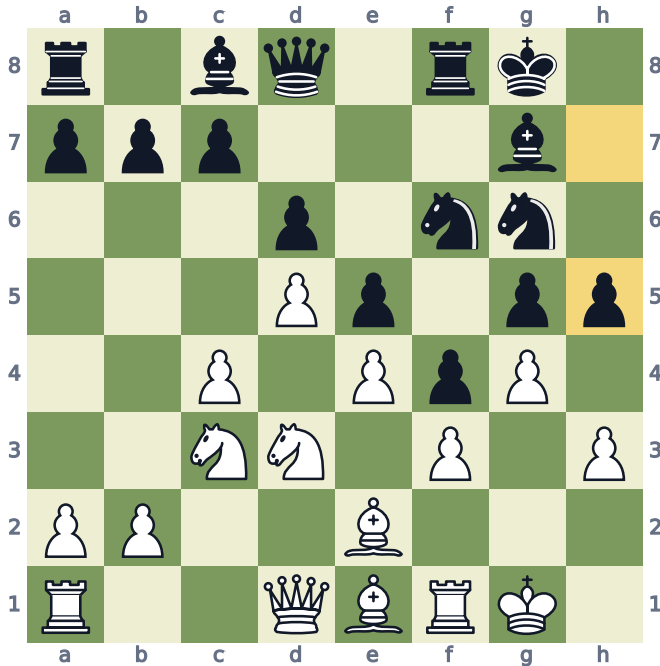
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

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- Be1: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- g5: Black gains or fixes kingside space and prepares line-opening contact for the pieces.
- g4: White claims space or creates a break that changes Black's available time and squares.
- Ng6: Black reroutes a knight toward g6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- h3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
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WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

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WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Count effective attackers and defenders before every pawn sacrifice. White's resistance is: White tries to keep the kingside closed while breaking with c5. The line fails as a template when: A familiar attacking shape does not prove a sacrifice.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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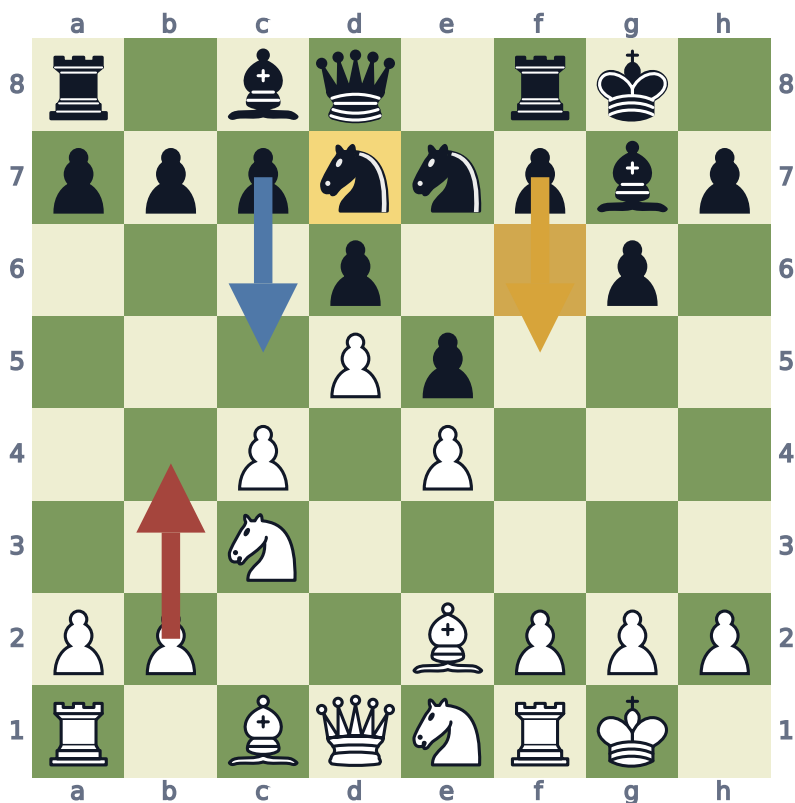
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 30 plies from memory, then replay: 13. Be1 g5 14. g4 Ng6 15. h3 h5

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The counterblow during the race

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

Both sides have advanced, so a forcing move on either wing can make the other plan irrelevant.

DECISION RULE

Recalculate from the actual board after every pawn contact.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Search checks, captures, and direct threats before continuing the pawn script.

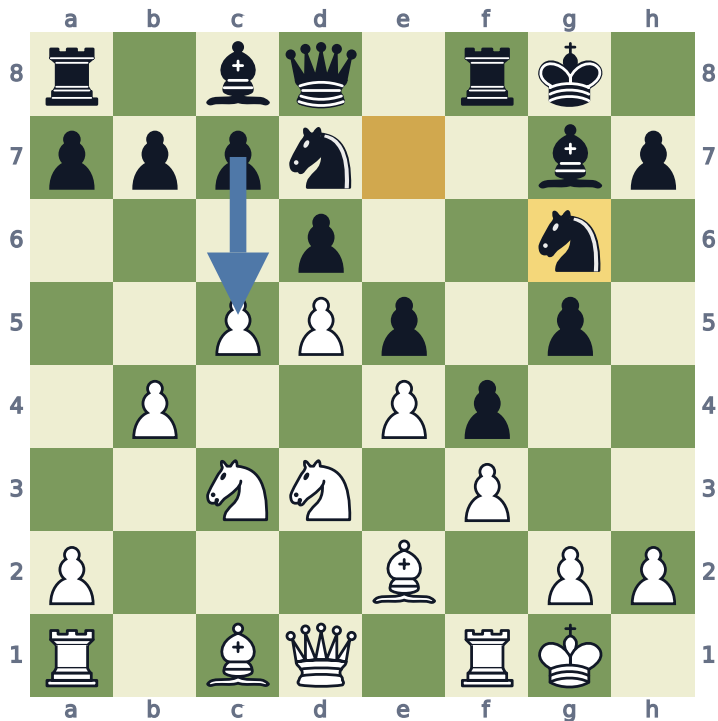
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may break cxd6, Nb5, or b5 while Black attacks the king.

MEMORY RULE | Every contact resets the calculation tree.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Both sides have advanced, so a forcing move on either wing can make the other plan irrelevant.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Search checks, captures, and direct threats before continuing the pawn script.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White may break $cx\text{d}6$, $Nb5$, or $b5$ while Black attacks the king.

FAILURE MODE

Continuing a memorized attack after the queenside opens can lose material with no mating compensation.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Recalculate from the actual board after every pawn contact. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

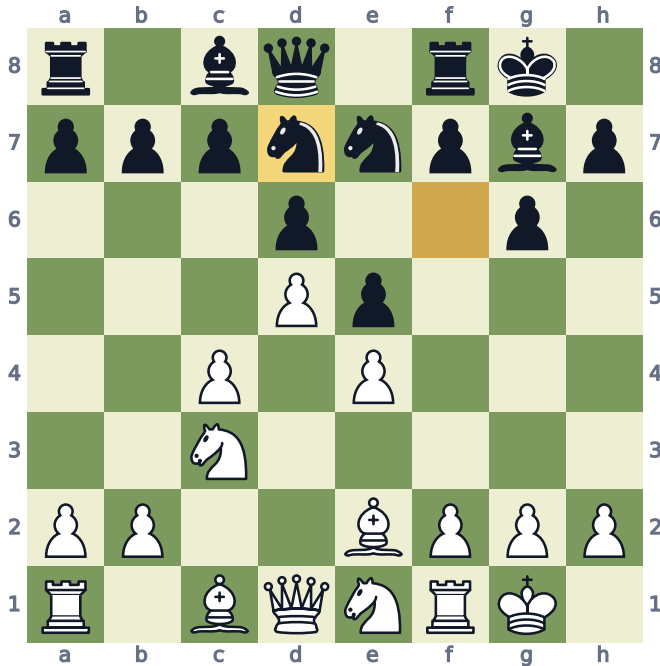
RULE | Every contact resets the calculation tree.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. f3 f4 12. b4 g5 13. c5 Ng6



- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight toward c6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- d5: White claims space or creates a break that changes Black's available time and squares.
- Ne7: Black reroutes a knight toward e7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Ne1: White reroutes a knight toward e1; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight toward d7; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Both sides have advanced, so a forcing move on either wing can make the other plan irrelevant.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Recalculate from the actual board after every pawn contact. White's resistance is: White may break cxd6, Nb5, or b5 while Black attacks the king. The line fails as a template when: Continuing a memorized attack after the queenside opens can lose material with no mating compensation.

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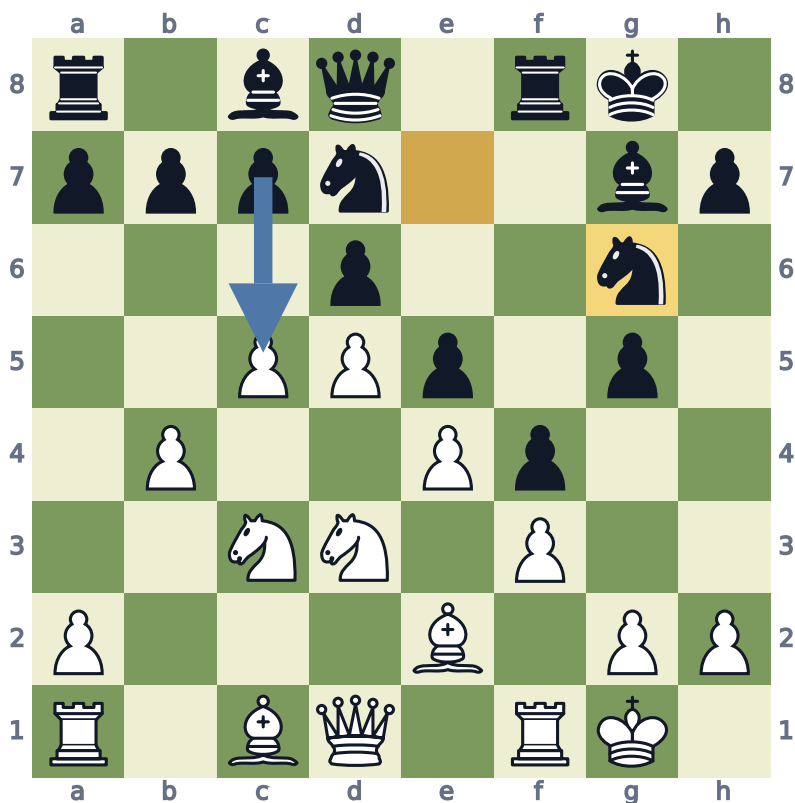
1. Both sides have advanced, so a forcing move on either wing can make the other plan irrelevant. 2. Search checks, captures, and direct threats before continuing the pawn script. 3. White may break cxd6, Nb5, or b5 while Black attacks the king. 4. Recalculate from the actual board after every pawn contact. 5. Continuing a memorized attack after the queenside opens can lose material with no mating compensation.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The counterblow during the race



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Both sides have advanced, so a forcing move on either wing can make the other plan irrelevant.

DECISION RULE

Recalculate from the actual board after every pawn contact.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

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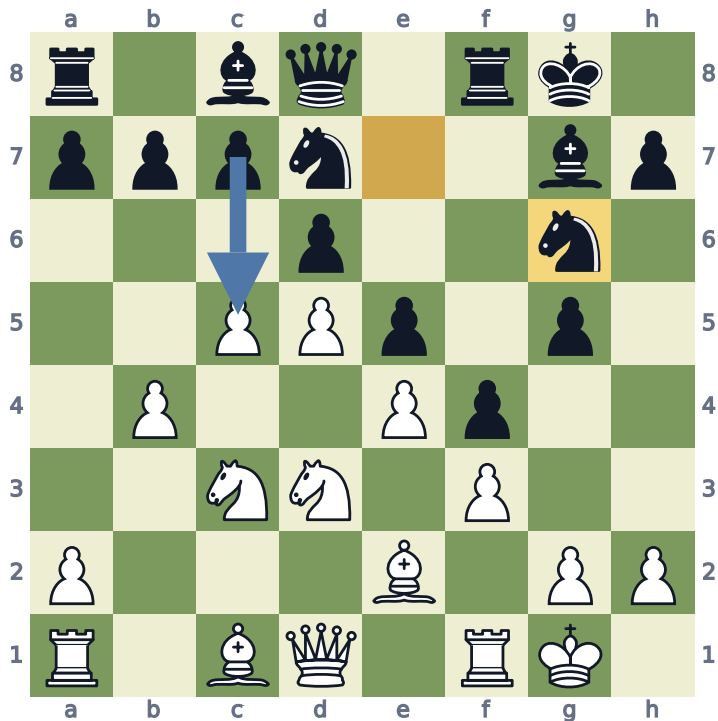
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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

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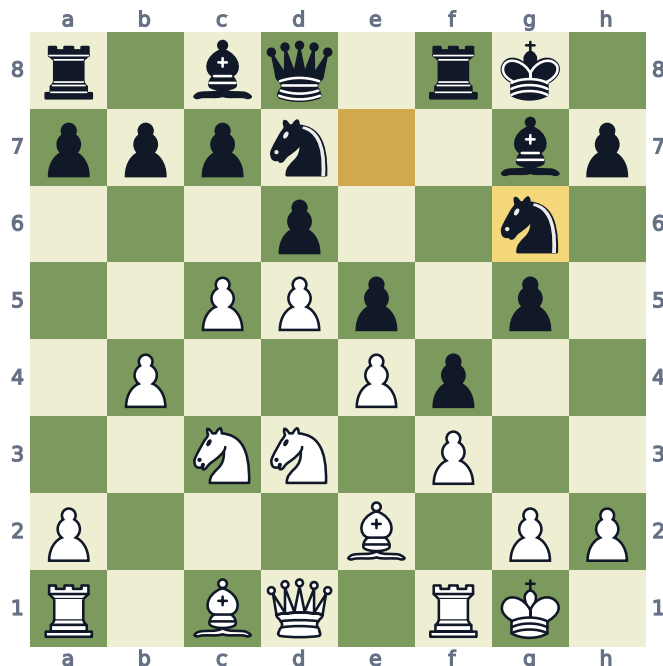
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Move-by-move meaning

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- f3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- f4: Black gains or fixes kingside space and prepares line-opening contact for the pieces.
- b4: White claims space or creates a break that changes Black's available time and squares.
- g5: Black gains or fixes kingside space and prepares line-opening contact for the pieces.
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5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. Both sides have advanced, so a forcing move on either wing can make the other plan irrelevant. 2. Search checks, captures, and direct threats before continuing the pawn script. 3. White may break cxd6, Nb5, or b5 while Black attacks the king. 4. Recalculate from the actual board after every pawn contact. 5. Continuing a memorized attack after the queenside opens can lose material with no mating compensation.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 26 plies from memory, then replay: 11. f3 f4 12. b4 g5 13. c5 Ng6

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 079 Decode: The f4 wedge

Prompt: Decide whether ...g5, ...g4, or a piece maneuver is the next forcing step.

Recall: The wedge restricts; another move must open access.

LESSON 080 Play: The f4 wedge

Prompt: Decide whether ...g5, ...g4, or a piece maneuver is the next forcing step.

Recall: The wedge restricts; another move must open access.

LESSON 081 Decode: The g4 contact

Prompt: Count effective attackers and defenders before every pawn sacrifice.

Recall: Pattern recognition finds the move; calculation earns it.

LESSON 082 Play: The g4 contact

Prompt: Count effective attackers and defenders before every pawn sacrifice.

Recall: Pattern recognition finds the move; calculation earns it.

LESSON 083 Decode: The counterblow during the race

Prompt: Recalculate from the actual board after every pawn contact.

Recall: Every contact resets the calculation tree.

LESSON 084 Play: The counterblow during the race

Prompt: Recalculate from the actual board after every pawn contact.

Recall: Every contact resets the calculation tree.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

The f4 wedge

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. f3 f4

Decision: Decide whether ...g5, ...g4, or a piece maneuver is the next forcing step.

Memory: The wedge restricts; another move must open access.

CARD 2

The g4 contact

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. Bd2 Nf6 12. f3 f4 13. Be1 g5 14. g4 Ng6 15. h3 h5

Decision: Count effective attackers and defenders before every pawn sacrifice.

Memory: Pattern recognition finds the move; calculation earns it.

CARD 3

The counterblow during the race

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Nd3 f5 11. f3 f4 12. b4 g5 13. c5 Ng6

Decision: Recalculate from the actual board after every pawn contact.

Memory: Every contact resets the calculation tree.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
079 Decode: The f4 wedge	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
080 Play: The f4 wedge	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
081 Decode: The g4 contact	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
082 Play: The g4 contact	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
083 Decode: The counterblow during the race	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
084 Play: The counterblow during the race	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.